

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

GHL Sub-Account Baseline Build

Standing up a client sub-account the Easyworks way,
from empty to ready for automations

EW-TECH-04 · v1.0 · 2026-09-10

Owner: Brad Palmer · For: Technical Builders



WHAT THIS IS

This is the build every client gets before a single automation is switched on. Use it the day Brad creates a new client sub-account. It produces a sub-account with a clean profile, the Easyworks baseline fields, values and tags, a sales pipeline, a working phone number, a booking calendar, a verified sending domain, connected integrations, and a state file that matches reality.

DONE MEANS

Every item in the Baseline Complete checklist (section 10) is ticked, the state file was updated today, and Brad has approved the handoff to EW-TECH-05 GH L Automations Playbook.

01 The build at a glance



Gold boxes are gates. Only Brad creates sub-accounts, creates the PIT, and touches the secrets file.

Brad	Builder (you)	Client	GuapBot
Creates the sub-account and the PIT. Adds secrets. Connects Stripe. Approves the handoff to automations.	Everything inside the sub-account: profile, pipeline, phone, calendars, domain, integrations, state file, verification.	Supplies the assets, accepts the user invites, connects their own Google and Facebook logins, confirms the booking flow works.	Runs the optimizer script with the PIT when Brad asks, records secrets, can re-snapshot the state file.

Read the whole document once before you touch the sub-account. The order matters: the PIT must exist before the optimizer, the phone number must be registered before any text is sent, and the state file is written the same day, not later.

ACCESS RULE

You work inside the client sub-account only, through a proper GH L user invite. Never the agency account, never Stripe, never the secrets file, never client billing. If a step in this document seems to need any of those, stop and message Brad.

02 Before you start: what the client must provide

Nothing in this build is guesswork. Every profile field, every number and every link comes from the client. Collect these first (the full asset list lives in the onboarding SOP; this is the subset the sub-account needs).

Client asset checklist (sub-account subset)

- ☐ Legal business name, the public brand name if different, and the street address
- ☐ Public business phone number (the one on their website and Google listing)
- ☐ Business email that will receive lead notifications, plus the owner's mobile for SMS alerts
- ☐ Website URL and logo file (PNG or SVG, on a transparent or white background)
- ☐ Time zone and business hours, including days closed
- ☐ The services they sell, in the words they use with customers (feeds Service Interest and Job Type)
- ☐ Google Business Profile: confirmation the client owns it and can add us as a manager
- ☐ Facebook Page (and Instagram if used): the client will log in and connect it themselves
- ☐ Google Calendar the bookings should land in, and who on their team takes bookings
- ☐ Whether they text customers in the US, in Canada, or both (drives the phone and A2P work)
- ☐ Existing customer list as CSV if they want it imported (name, phone, email, last job date)

NO SHARED PASSWORDS

Ask for invites, never passwords. GBP manager invite, GA4 viewer invite, Facebook Page role. If a client offers their password, decline and send them the invite steps instead.

ENGAGEMENT GATE

Paper before production. Do not start this build until Brad confirms the signed agreement, payment terms and scope sheet exist. A demo sub-account for a prospect is a different thing and Brad will say so.

03 Stage 1: sub-account and business profile

Gate: sub-account creation (Brad)

Brad creates the sub-account from the agency (either in the agency UI or through the Easyworks onboard endpoint). You receive the location ID and a user invite by email. Accept the invite, log in, and confirm the location ID in the browser URL matches what Brad sent.

1

Open Settings, then Business Profile

Confirm the sub-account name is the client's brand name, not a placeholder. Fill in every field from the asset checklist: legal name, address, phone, email, website, time zone.

2

Set the time zone before anything else

Calendars, workflow waits and quiet hours all read this value. A wrong time zone here means every reminder fires at the wrong hour.

Test: after saving, open a calendar and check the displayed hours match the client's local time.

3

Upload the logo

Business Profile, logo field. This is UI only; the API cannot upload it. Check it shows on the booking widget and in email templates.

4

Set business hours in the profile if the field exists in your view

Some accounts show hours on the profile, others only on calendars. If you do not see it, skip and set hours on the calendar in Stage 4.

5

Verify

Reload the page. Every field persists. Take one screenshot for the task notes.

WHY THE PROFILE IS A UI JOB

A sub-account PIT can read the location profile but cannot update it by API. Profile edits are done in the UI (Settings, Business Profile) or by Brad with the agency token. Do not spend time trying to PUT the location record with a PIT; it returns 401.

04 Stage 2: PIT, baseline optimizer, pipeline

Gate: Private Integration Token (Brad)

The PIT is the API key for this sub-account. It is created in the GHL UI only (Settings, Private Integrations), with all scopes, named after the client (for example "Alltight Full Control"). Brad creates it and stores it in the secrets file as `GHL_CLIENTNAME_PIT_TOKEN` with `GHL_CLIENTNAME_LOCATION_ID`. The PIT lives in the secrets file, Brad holds it. You never see it, paste it, or ask for it.

The baseline optimizer

Brad or GuapBot runs `~/easyworks/optimize-client.sh <locationId> <PIT> "Name" phone email website`. It is idempotent: run it twice and it skips anything that already exists. It creates the baseline below. It cannot create the pipeline (the API does not allow it), so the pipeline is your job in the UI right after.

Custom field	Type	Options
Lead Source	Single option	Website, Referral, Google, Social, Door to Door, Other
Service Interest	Text	
Job Type	Text	
Quote Amount	Monetary	(the API spells this dataType MONETORY)
Quote Sent	Date	
Job Status	Single option	New, Quoted, Scheduled, In Progress, Completed, Lost
Preferred Contact Method	Single option	Phone, Email, Text

Custom value	Set to	Used for
Company Name	Client brand name	Every message signature
Company Phone	Public business number	Message footers, review asks
Company Email	Lead notification inbox	Internal notifications
Website	Client site URL	Email footers
Booking Link	Blank until Stage 4, then the public booking URL	Every booking CTA
Managed By	Easyworks AI Solutions	Internal reference only

Lifecycle tag	Applied when
new-lead	Contact created from any lead source
contacted	First outbound reply sent or first call made
quote-sent	Quote Amount filled and Quote Sent dated
customer	Opportunity marked Won or first payment
follow-up	Contact is inside a nurture sequence
no-response	Sequence finished with no reply
repeat-customer	Second Won opportunity

Verify the optimizer ran: Settings, Custom Fields shows the seven fields; Settings, Custom Values shows the six values with the client's data filled; Settings, Tags shows the seven tags. If any are missing, tell Brad and ask for a re-run; do not create them by hand with different spellings.

Build the sales pipeline in the UI

1

Open Opportunities, then Pipelines

Create a new pipeline named "<Client> Sales Pipeline". Leave the default Marketing Pipeline alone unless Brad says to delete it.

2

Add the standard stages, in this order

New Lead, Contacted, Booked / Site Visit, Quote Sent, Negotiation, Won, Lost. Rename "Booked / Site Visit" to what the client calls it (Site Visit Scheduled for trades, Consult Booked for clinics), but keep the position.

3

Verify

Create a test contact named "Test Easyworks" and add an opportunity in New Lead. Drag it through every stage. Delete the test opportunity after.

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

The Pipelines screen lives under Opportunities in most views and under Settings in others; the exact placement changes with GHIL releases.

Naming conventions (use everywhere)

Thing	Convention	Example
Tags	lowercase, words joined with hyphens, no spaces	quote-sent, fu-warm
Custom values	Title Case name; referenced in messages as <code>{{custom_values.name}}</code> where name is lowercase with underscores	<code>{{custom_values.booking_link}}</code>
Custom fields	Title Case, describes the data not the action	Quote Amount, not Send Quote
Workflows	"WF: purpose" so they sort together	WF: Missed Call Text Back
Calendars	What the client calls the appointment	Free Estimate, New Patient Consult
Pipelines	"<Client> Sales Pipeline"	Alltight Sales Pipeline

05 Stage 3: phone number and SMS compliance

A number that texts before it is registered gets filtered by carriers, and the client thinks the system is broken. Registration first, texting second, always.

1

Buy the number

Settings, Phone Numbers, Add Number. Pick the client's area code. Prefer a local number over toll free for a local service business. Name it after the client.

2

Set the forwarding

Point inbound calls to the client's real phone (the number they answer). Turn on call recording only if the client agreed in writing.

3

US clients: register A2P 10DLC

Settings, Phone Numbers, then the Trust Center or Regulatory area. Register the brand (legal name, EIN, address, website) and then a campaign (use case, sample messages, opt in description).

Sample messages must include the business name and an opt out line. Use the real copy from EW-TECH-05. Approval takes days, sometimes longer. Log the submission date in the state file.

4

Canadian clients

Canadian numbers do not go through 10DLC but carriers apply their own filtering. Keep volumes low, always include the business name, and honour STOP. If the client texts into the US from a Canadian number, ask Brad before sending anything.

5

Voice AI or missed call text back

Attach the Voice AI agent or the missed call text back later, in EW-TECH-05. For now the number only needs to ring through.

6

Verify

Call the number from your phone: it forwards. Do not send a test SMS until the campaign shows Approved.

NO TEXTS BEFORE APPROVAL

Never send a text from a US number before the A2P campaign is approved. Filtered texts do not bounce; they silently vanish, and the client assumes we lied. Treat "pending" as "not allowed".

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

The exact labels for the A2P screens (Trust Center vs Regulatory Bundle) and whether the client's own EIN or an Easyworks registration is used for a given client.

06 Stage 4: calendars and the booking link

1

Create the calendar

Calendars, Calendar Settings, New Calendar. Choose a simple one person calendar for a single owner, or round robin if more than one staff member takes bookings. Name it what the client calls the appointment.

2

Availability

Set weekly hours to the client's real booking hours, not their opening hours. One entry per weekday. Slot duration 30 minutes unless the service needs longer. Slot interval equal to the duration. Minimum notice 2 hours. Booking window 30 days ahead.

3

Buffers

Add a buffer before and after (15 minutes for clinics, 60 minutes for trades who drive). Set the maximum bookings per day if the client asked for a cap.

4

Connect the client's Google Calendar

Settings, Integrations, connect Google (the client logs in themselves). Then on the user's My Profile, Calendar Configuration, pick that Google calendar as the linked calendar and turn on the check for conflicts option so busy time blocks slots.

Test: put a fake event on the Google calendar. That slot must disappear from the booking widget within a few minutes.

5

Confirmation and reminders

In the calendar's Notifications tab turn on the booking confirmation (email and SMS) and reminders at 24 hours and 2 hours. The message copy and the reschedule link come from EW-TECH-05; use those exact texts so every client sounds the same.

6

Form and consent

Ask for first name, phone, email only. Add the consent checkbox for SMS. Turn off anything that adds friction.

7

Publish and copy the link

The public widget URL follows the pattern

<https://api.leadconnectorhq.com/widget/booking/<calendarId>>. Copy it from the calendar's share option.

Paste it into Settings, Custom Values, Booking Link. Every workflow reads it from there.

8

Verify as the client would

Open the link on your phone. Book a real slot with your own number. The confirmation arrives, the event shows in the client's Google Calendar, and the contact in GHL has the appointment. Then cancel it and delete the test contact.

DOUBLE BOOKING CHECKLIST

Double bookings almost always come from one of four places: availability hours set wrong, buffers missing, the Google calendar not linked to the right user, or slot interval smaller than slot duration. Check all four before you touch anything else.

07 Stage 5: email sending domain

Without a verified domain, email from the sub-account arrives from a generic relay address and lands in spam. The client gives you DNS access or you send them the records to add.

1

Add a dedicated sending domain

Settings, Email Services, Dedicated Domain, Add Domain. Use a subdomain of the client's site, for example mail.<clientdomain>.com, so the root domain is never at risk.

2

Publish the DNS records

GHL shows the records to add at the client's DNS host: the CNAME or TXT records for domain verification and DKIM, plus SPF. Add a DMARC record at the root domain if the client has none (v=DMARC1; p=none; with the client's reporting address is a safe start).

3

Verify

Back in Email Services, click verify. All records show green. Send a test email to your own Gmail and check the headers show SPF pass and DKIM pass.

4

Warm up

For the first two weeks keep sends low and human (notifications, confirmations, replies). No bulk campaign, no reactivation blast, until the domain has two weeks of clean sends.

5

Set the default from name and address

Settings, Email Services, the from name is the client brand, the address is on the new subdomain, replies go to the client's real inbox.

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

The DMARC policy value and whether Brad wants a shared Easyworks sending domain for some smaller clients instead of a client subdomain.

08 Stage 6: integrations

Integration	Who connects	Where	Verify
Google Business Profile	Client (their Google login), after adding us as manager	Settings, Integrations, Google Business Profile	Reputation shows the listing; GBP messaging appears in Conversations
Facebook Page + Lead Forms	Client (their Facebook login), Page admin role	Settings, Integrations, Facebook; then map each lead form	Submit a test lead in Facebook's Lead Ads testing tool; contact appears in GHL
Instagram	Client, Business or Creator account linked to the Page	Same Facebook integration screen	Instagram DMs land in Conversations

Integration	Who connects	Where	Verify
Google Calendar	The client user who takes bookings	Settings, Integrations, Google; then My Profile, Calendar Configuration	Fake Google event blocks a booking slot
Stripe	Brad only	Settings, Payments	Brad confirms; never touch this
Website forms	Builder	Site form posts to GHL by webhook or API (see the web SOP)	Form submit creates a contact with Lead Source = Website

SOCIAL CONNECT RULE

Social posting goes through the GHL Social Planner under the client's own connection, never through a system user we control. That route caused Meta bans in the past. The client does the one time connect; we schedule.

09 Stage 7: the state file and the handoff

Every client sub-account has one state file, `ghl_state_client_<name>.md`. It is the memory of what is configured: profile, pipeline and stages, custom fields, custom values, tags, calendars and their IDs, phone number and A2P status, sending domain status, integrations, workflows. GuapBot and Brad rely on it before touching a client, so a stale file causes real mistakes.

SAME DAY STATE FILE RULE

Any change to a sub-account, by UI or by API, is written to the state file the same day, with the "Last synced" date bumped. No exceptions, no "I will do it Friday". If you changed it and did not record it, the change does not exist.

1

Record

Send Brad or GuapBot the list of what you built (or edit the file yourself if you have been given access to it). Include IDs: calendar IDs, pipeline stage names, the phone number, the domain and its status.

2

Attach proof

Screenshots or a short Loom of the booking test, the pipeline, and the verified domain, in the task notes.

3

Move the task to review

Brad checks the sub-account against the Baseline Complete checklist. Only Brad marks it done.

4

Handoff

Once approved, open EW-TECH-05 GHL Automations Playbook and start with WF: Missed Call Text Back and WF: Speed to Lead. Nothing texts a real lead until the A2P campaign is approved.

10 Baseline complete, definition of done

Definition of done

- ☐ Business Profile complete: name, address, phone, email, website, time zone, logo (screenshot attached)
- ☐ PIT created by Brad and stored in the secrets file (Brad confirms; you never saw it)
- ☐ Optimizer run: 7 custom fields, 6 custom values with real data, 7 lifecycle tags present
- ☐ "<Client> Sales Pipeline" built with the 7 standard stages, tested with a test opportunity, test data deleted
- ☐ Phone number bought, forwards to the client, A2P brand and campaign submitted (US) with date logged, or Canadian rules noted
- ☐ No SMS sent from the number before campaign approval
- ☐ Calendar built: availability, buffers, Google calendar linked, confirmation + 24h + 2h reminders on, booking tested on a phone
- ☐ Booking Link custom value filled with the public widget URL
- ☐ Sending domain verified (SPF, DKIM, DMARC green), test email passes, warm up plan noted
- ☐ GBP, Facebook Page and lead forms, Google Calendar connected by the client; Stripe left to Brad
- ☐ Website form creates a contact with Lead Source set
- ☐ State file updated today with every ID and status; task moved to review with screenshots

When it goes wrong

Symptom	First three checks	Who to tell
Optimizer says skip on everything	1. Was it already run (idempotent, skip is fine). 2. Right location ID. 3. PIT scopes (Brad checks)	Brad, only if fields are actually missing
Cannot edit the business profile	1. You are in the sub-account, not the agency. 2. Your user role has settings access. 3. It is a field the API set; edit in UI	Brad if the role is wrong
Texts not arriving from the new number	1. A2P campaign status (pending means filtered). 2. Number is SMS capable. 3. Contact is not DND	Brad, same day
Calendar double books or shows wrong slots	1. Availability hours and time zone. 2. Buffers and slot interval. 3. Google calendar linked to the right user with conflict check on	Client if their Google login dropped
Booking link 404 or blank	1. Calendar is active, not draft. 2. Copied the full widget URL. 3. Custom value pasted without spaces	Brad if the calendar ID looks wrong
Emails land in spam	1. Domain shows verified. 2. SPF and DKIM pass in the test headers. 3. Sending volume during warm up	Brad if DNS is at a host we cannot reach
Facebook leads not creating contacts	1. Page connected under the client's login. 2. Lead form mapped to fields. 3. Test lead sent from the Lead Ads testing tool	Client to reconnect, Brad if mapping fails
Integration banner says Fix This	1. Which Google or Facebook account dropped. 2. It is the client's login, they must reconnect. 3. Log it in the state file	Client, then Brad
Profile PUT returns 401	1. Expected with a PIT. 2. Edit in UI instead. 3. If it must be API, Brad uses the agency token	Brad only if UI also fails